



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

Policy and Standard Operating Procedures for Conducting Internal Audits

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Contents

1.0	Introduction	2
2.0	Purpose	2
3.0	Scope	2
4.0	Policy Statements	2
5.0	Abbreviations and Acronyms	3
6.0	Definitions	3
7.0	Responsibilities	5
8.0	Standard Operating Procedures	5
9.0	Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles	8
10.0	Relevant Audit Forms/Documents:	8
	Appendix 1	9
	JCF Audit Programme and Procedure	9
	JCF L e a d Auditor Evaluation Form	10
	JCF Auditor Evaluation Form	12

1.0 Introduction

A system of laws, regulations, policies, and standard operating procedures governs the Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF). A major requirement for the execution of the organization's function is the commitment to transparency and accountability, and the assurance that it is operating most efficiently and effectively. Internal audit is one of many tools the JCF will employ to ensure compliance with laws, regulations, policies, and procedures. Not only will audit present a framework within which the organization can demonstrate commitment to transparency and accountability, but also importantly, audit aids in identifying ways to improve performances; provides information for management reviews, and, ensures the effectiveness of systems and processes. This Policy and Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) underlies the organization's commitment to a Quality Management System by providing the authority and procedure for conducting the internal audit of the organization's management system, processes, and procedures.

2.0 Purpose

This policy and standard operating procedures enhance the organization's standards by strengthening internal audit mechanisms. They demonstrate the organization's commitment to best practices and quality services. The policy sets out a standardized way to manage internal audits within the organization.

3.0 Scope

This Policy and Standard Operating Procedure applies to all members permitted to conduct internal audits of formations within the JCF. It covers the audit process, related corrections, and corrective actions derived from or associated with it.

4.0 Policy Statements

This policy and standard operating procedure assesses the efficiency, effectiveness and compliance of the Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF) processes and practices with relevant policies, regulations and standard, to reaffirms its commitment to develop and institute a Quality Management System that will consistently deliver services that meet and exceed customer expectations and regulatory requirements and increase accountability, transparency, efficiency, and effectiveness of its systems and processes. To this end, the JCF internal audits are conducted to ensure:

- 4.1 Adherence to laws, regulations, policies, prescribed standards, procedures, application of best practices, and the achievement of strategic objectives;
 - 4.1.1 Assess the level of conformity to all requirements and standards for certification;
 - 4.1.2 Identify opportunities for the maintenance and improvement of the management system and its performance;

- 4.1.3 Evaluate the compatibility and alignment of the Quality Management System objectives with the Strategic direction; and
- 4.1.4 Ensure that best practices are identified, replicated, and non-conformities appropriately addressed.

5.0 Abbreviations and Acronyms

ACP	Assistant Commissioner of Police
AF	Audit Form
CAR	Corrective Action Request Form
CAV	Corrective Action Verification Form
IG	Inspector General
JCF	Jamaica Constabulary Force
MAJ. NC	Major Non-conformity
MIN. NC	Minor Non-conformity
PRDB	Planning, Research and Development Branch
QAD	Quality Assurance Directorate

6.0 Definitions

- 6.1 **An Audit**
A systematic, independent, and documented process for obtaining objective evidence and evaluating it objectively to determine the extent to which the audit criteria are fulfilled
- 6.2 **Auditee**
An organization or part thereof that is being audited
- 6.3 **Auditor**
The person conducting an audit
- 6.4 **Process Owner**
The individual responsible for an Area, Portfolio, Division, Formation, Unit, or a part thereof of the site under audit
- 6.5 **Audit Criteria**
A set of requirements is used as a reference against which objective evidence is compared
- 6.6 **Audit Director**
A top-level manager who provides strategic oversight for the JCF internal audit programme
- 6.7 **Audit Manager**
A senior manager responsible for managing the organization's comprehensive internal audit programme to ensure successful execution and adherence to audit requirements, standards, and best practices

- 6.8 **Assistant Audit Manager**
Acts as a proxy for the Audit Manager, and is responsible for the planning, scheduling, and coordinating, inter alia, while reporting to the Audit Manager
- 6.9 **Classification of Non-conformity**
- 6.9.1 **Major Non-conformity (Maj. NC):**
A non-conformity that has the potential to cause significant failure of the JCF services, operations, or objectives, likely to result in hazardous conditions for individuals using, maintaining, or depending upon the services, or prevent performance of a vital mission or mandate of the JCF.
- 6.9.2 **Minor Non-conformity (Min. NC)**
A non-conformity that, in the auditor's judgment and experience, is not likely to fail the JCF's Quality Management System.
- 6.10 **Opening Meeting**
A formal gathering with the appropriate personnel that signifies the start of the audit process and sets the overall tone for the audit
- 6.11 **Closing Meeting**
The closing meeting is a formal assembly held at the conclusion of the audit process, during which the auditors meet to review and discuss the audit findings
- 6.12 **Conformity**
Fulfillment of a requirement
- 6.13 **Non-conformity**
Non-fulfillment of a condition (A deficiency in the JCF's process, system, or service resulting from a failure to meet quality or performance standards, requirements, or operational specifications)
- 6.14 **Correction**
An action is taken to immediately fix to a specific problem/issue/non-conformity
- 6.15 **Corrective Action**
A process that addresses the root cause of a problem/issue/nonconformity to prevent its recurrence
- 6.16 **Lead Auditor**
The individual who is responsible for managing an audit and supervising the team assigned to conduct it.
- 6.17 **Objective Evidence**
Supporting and verifiable information, such as records, data, and observations that demonstrate compliance with standards

- 6.18 **Observer**
An individual who accompanies the audit team but does not act as an auditor
- 6.19 **Technical Expert**
A person who provides specific knowledge or expertise to the audit team
- 6.20 **Technical Advisor**
Refers to a person(s) who provide expertise to ensure the effective operation of the QMS and compliance with relevant standards and regulations

7.0 Responsibilities

- 7.1 **The following outlines the responsibilities for internal audit:**
- 7.1.1 The Director has overall responsibility for the organization's internal audit programme.
 - 7.1.2 The Audit Manager coordinates audit activities, including preparing audit plans, schedules, and reports inter alia.
 - 7.1.3 The Assistant Audit Manager will act as the proxy to the Audit Manager where necessary
 - 7.1.4 The Lead Auditor will manage an audit and supervise the team assigned to conduct the audit.
 - 7.1.5 An auditor is responsible for conducting internal audits in all formations.
- 7.2 **Quality Management System (QMS) Annual Audit**
- 7.2.1 The Quality Assurance Directorate will ensure that an annual QMS internal audit is conducted.
 - 7.2.2 Assess the JCF's systems and processes:
 - 7.2.3 To analyze the number of previous non-conformances and the impact it has on the processes/services of the organization.
 - 7.2.4 The impact that audit activities might have on the delivery of service.
 - 7.2.5 Prepare a report detailing the findings of the audit based on the assessment of systems and processes, and submit it to the Inspector General.
 - 7.2.6 Distribute the report, present the findings to the Executive Management Board (EMB), and deliver a presentation at the Quality Management System (QMS) Steering Committee meeting.

8.0 Standard Operating Procedures

Where a formation has been scheduled or selected to be audited, the following shall apply:

- 8.1 **Selection of Auditors**
- 8.1.1 The JCF recognizes that auditor competence is essential to the process. JCF auditors are trained to enhance accountability and objectivity while upholding independence, professional judgment, and ethical behaviour.

Consequently, the following prerequisites are used to select the audit team:

- 8.1.2 Possess at least three (3) years' service as a sworn or unsworn member of the Jamaica Constabulary Force.
- 8.1.3 Knowledge of law and policing functions;
- 8.1.4 Is exposed to the ISO 19011: 2018 Audit Standard, ISO 9001:2015 Standard, JCF Quality Management Policy, and other relevant policies and SOPs, JCF administrative guidelines and directives;
- 8.1.5 Completed at least sixteen (16) hours of training in audit principles, techniques, and procedures.
- 8.1.6 Demonstrate proficiency in performing conformance and compliance audits.
- 8.1.7 Ability to plan, organize, direct, control, and coordinate management activities
- 8.1.8 Possess good administrative and analytical skills; and
- 8.1.9 Possess very good oral and written communication skills

8.2 Conditions for an Audit

To give greater effect to the internal audit process, it is the policy that:

- 8.2.1 All formations' management systems and processes are subjected to periodic or special audits;
- 8.2.2 Auditors will not perform audits in formations to which they are assigned or in which they operate;
- 8.2.3 Auditee will comply with all reasonable requests from the Lead Auditor.
- 8.2.4 Where there is/are reason(s) to refuse a request, the head of the formation being audited must submit in writing within two (2) days of such request to the Audit Manager, reason (s) for objection; and
- 8.2.5 The Audit Manager shall consult with the Director, who will decide on all objections.

8.3 Pre-Audit Activities

- 8.3.1 Circulation of the Audit Plan via the JCF's weekly Force Orders at least three (3) weeks before the audit.
- 8.3.2 Select the audit team(s) and appoint Lead Auditor(s).
- 8.3.3 Conduct Document Review (determining the audit requirements such as appropriate laws, regulations, policies, and standard operating procedures that set the standard and criteria against which the audit must be conducted)
- 8.3.4 Establish contact with the Auditee
- 8.3.5 Determining the logistics and welfare arrangements for the audit team.
- 8.3.6 Conduct the Opening Meeting on day one of the audit.

8.4 Conducting the Audit

The Lead Auditor meets with the audit team, discusses requirements for the audit, conducts the audit, informs the Auditee of the preliminary findings, and submits the report to the Audit Manager.

8.5 Preliminary Audit Report

On the submission of the audit findings, the Director will:

- 8.5.1 Communicate the preliminary findings to the Inspector General and the High Command.
- 8.5.2 Make a presentation of the preliminary findings at the QMS Steering Committee Meeting.

8.6 Submission of the Final Report

The final report is presented to the High Command. It will outline the findings of the audit.

8.7 Closing Meeting

The Director/Audit Manager will:

- 8.7.1 Communicate the findings to the auditee.
- 8.7.2 Communicate the corrective action process and the timeline for returning the CAR forms
- 8.7.3 Advise the auditee of the rejection process
- 8.7.4 Advise the auditee of the implementation of the corrective action

8.8 Post Audit and Monitoring

On conclusion of an audit, the following activities will be conducted:

- 8.8.1 Tracking of CAR Forms and updating the Internal Audit Management System (IAMS).
- 8.8.2 Conduct verification and surveillance
- 8.8.3 The Lead Auditor will assess the auditors utilizing the *JCF Auditor Evaluation Form (See Appendix 2.)*
- 8.8.4 The Auditee will assess the Lead Auditor utilizing the *JCF Lead Auditor Evaluation Form (See Appendix 3.)*

8.9 Procedure for Addressing Rejection of Non-conformity

Where an auditee rejects the audit findings, the following procedure shall apply;

- 8.9.1 Contact the process owner to discuss their rejection of the non-conformity.
- 8.9.2 Request a detailed explanation with supporting arguments or evidence.
- 8.9.3 Document the process owner's rationale for rejection in a formal document.
- 8.9.4 Identify the objective evidence that support the non-conformity.
- 8.9.5 Review/analyze the evidence that supports the claims and collect additional data if needed.
- 8.9.6 Audit manager consults with lead auditor and process owner(s) for feedback on the rejection and its implications.
- 8.9.7 Establish Review Panel if necessary.

8.10 Review Panel

The Audit Manager shall establish the Review Panel (RP) to examine the non-conformity that has been challenged/rejected by the Process Owner.

8.10.1 **Composition of the Review Panel:** The Review Panel shall consist of two

(2) Lead Auditors, the Audit Manager or his/her designate, and a recording Secretary.

8.10.2 **Deliberation and Decision-Making:** The panel, along with the auditee, will discuss issues related to the non-conformities and arrive at a conclusive decision:

- a. Maintaining the current status of the non-conformity
- b. Accepting the Process Owner's rejection
- c. Downgrading/upgrading the non-conformity

8.10.3 The determination made by the Review Panel shall be considered final. An official communication will be sent to the Process Owner.

9.0 Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles

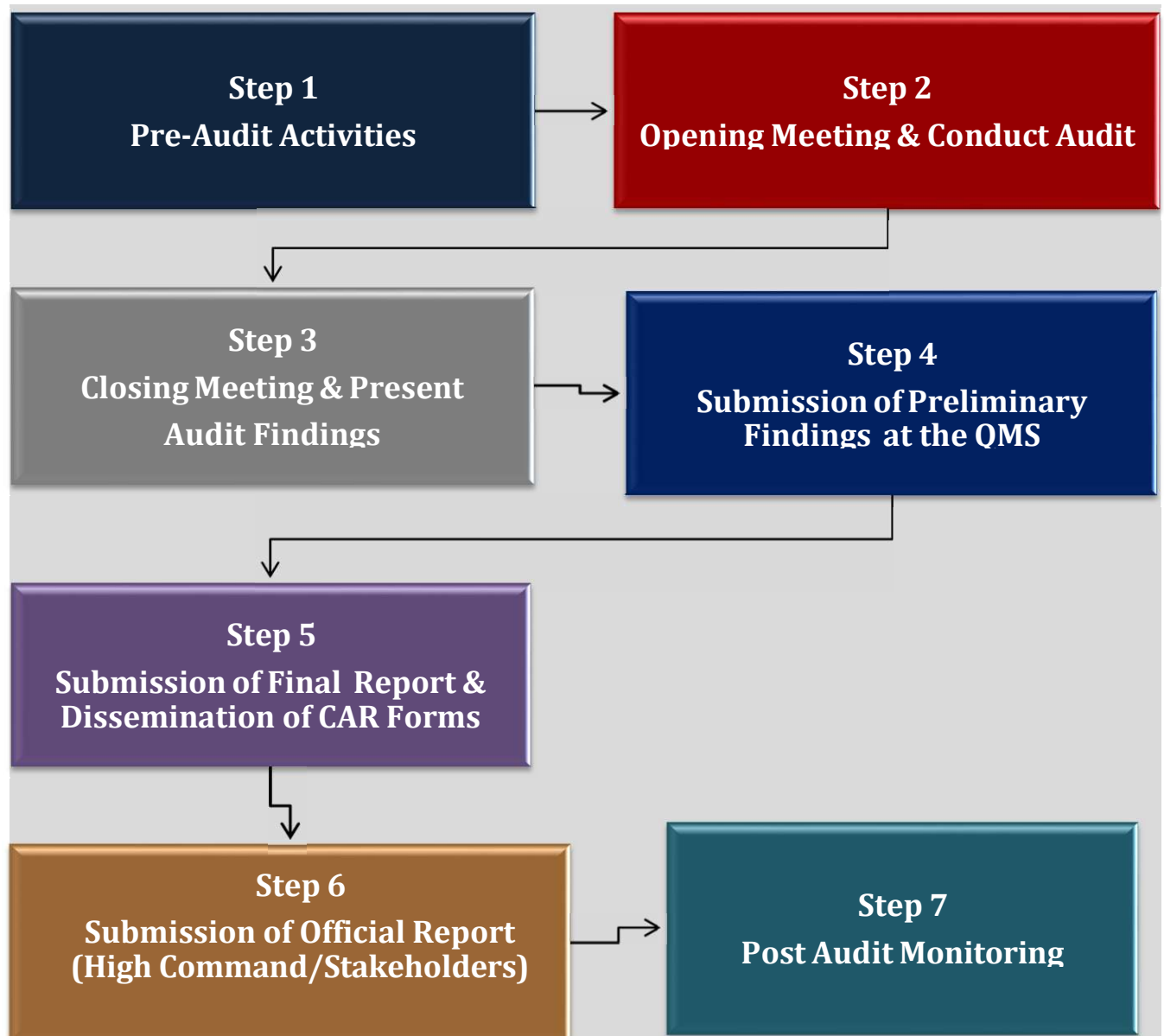
This policy and the standard operating procedure are in keeping with The JCF Quality Management Standards, JCF Policies, Regulations, and Standard Operating Procedures, and applicable laws.

10.0 Relevant Audit Forms/Documents/Records:

- 10.1 Audit Plan
- 10.2 Corrective Action Request Form (CAR)
- 10.3 Internal Audit Checklist
- 10.4 Corrective Action Verification (CAV) Form
- 10.5 Internal Audit Management System (IAMS)
- 10.6 Audit Meeting Register
- 10.7 Audit Training Register
- 10.8 JCF Lead Auditor Evaluation Form
- 10.9 JCF Auditor Evaluation Form

Appendix 1: JCF Audit Programme and Procedure

Process Flow



Appendix 3: JCF Lead Auditor Evaluation Form

JCF/IPROB-QAD/PL/SFs/0001/2023/F01  JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE INSPECTORATE AND PROFESSIONAL STANDARDS OVERSIGHT BUREAU QUALITY ASSURANCE DIRECTORATE			
Subject: JCF Lead Auditor Evaluation Form			
Page 1 of 2		Approved By: Inspector General	
Revision Level: 1		Issue Date: 20.01.2025	Last Revised: 29.04.2025

Date of Audit	Site Audited	Rank/Rag.No/Position	Name of Auditor

Instruction: This form must be completed by the Auditee. Please tick [✓] whether the auditor is: ☐ Internal ☐ External

Rate the individual above on a scale of 1 to 5, with 5 being the highest.

Qualities	1	2	3	4	5
Technical Knowledge: (Demonstrated a solid understanding of ISO Standards, QMS Principles, and JCF Policies and Procedures)					
Analytical Skills: (Demonstrated the ability to analyze data and processes thoroughly, interpret accurately, and assess conformance to quality standards)					
Integrity and Confidentiality: (Dedicated to honesty, ethical conduct, objectivity, and upholding confidentiality of sensitive information gathered during the audit process)					
Professionalism: (Displayed a strong level of expertise in interactions with auditees, consistently maintaining a respectful attitude)					
Efficiency and Thoroughness: (Executed a meticulous and effective audit)					
Leadership and Facilitation: (Demonstrated strong leadership and facilitation skills to gain comprehensive insights from auditees)					
Management of Time: (Executed a thorough audit within the designated timeframe)					

General Comments: _____

1



**JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE
INSPECTORATE AND PROFESSIONAL STANDARDS OVERSIGHT BUREAU
QUALITY ASSURANCE DIRECTORATE**

Subject: JCF Lead Auditor Evaluation Form

Page 2 of 2

Approved By: Inspector General

Revision Level: 1

Issue Date: 20.01.2025

Last Revised: 29.04.2025

Auditee Signature Date.....

Internal Audit Administrative Use Only: Evaluation Criteria & Weightings

Criterion	Weighting (%)	Rating (1-5)	Score (Rating / 5 * Weighting)
Technical Knowledge	20%		
Analytical Skills	15%		
Integrity and Confidentiality	15%		
Professionalism	15%		
Efficiency and Thoroughness	15%		
Leadership and Facilitation	10%		
Management of Time	10%		
Total	100%		
Overall Percentage			

Appendix 3: JCF Audit Evaluation Form

JCF/IPROB-QAD/PL/SFs/0001/2023/F02			
 JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE INSPECTORATE AND PROFESSIONAL STANDARDS OVERSIGHT BUREAU QUALITY ASSURANCE DIRECTORATE			
Subject: JCF Auditor Evaluation Form			
Page 1 of 2		Approved By: Inspector General	
Revision Level: 1		Issue Date: 20.01.2025	Last Revised: 29.04.2025

Date of Audit	Site Audited	Rank/Rag. No./Position	Name of Auditor

Instruction: This form must be completed by the Lead Auditor. Please tick [✓] whether the auditor is: ☐ Internal ☐ External

Rate the individual above on a scale of 1 to 5, with 5 being the highest.

Qualities	1	2	3	4	5
Involvement in Pre-Audit Activities: (The auditor actively participated in pre-audit tasks, offered valuable feedback, maintained engagement, communicated effectively, and managed time efficiently.)	□	□	□	□	□
Engagement During the Audit Process: (The auditor was thorough in documenting evidence and actively participated in caucus meetings)	□	□	□	□	□
Auditor's Competence (The auditor showed very good skills in interviewing, observation, analysis, and communication, with solid knowledge of standards and policies)	□	□	□	□	□
Principles of Auditing: (Maintained confidentiality, independence, and integrity; exercised due professional care; ensured fair and accurate reporting; and relied on relevant, verifiable evidence)	□	□	□	□	□
Leadership and Facilitation: (The auditor showed strong skills in engaging with auditees professionally and respectfully)	□	□	□	□	□

General Comments: _____

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**JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE
INSPECTORATE AND PROFESSIONAL STANDARDS OVERSIGHT BUREAU
QUALITY ASSURANCE DIRECTORATE**

Subject: JCF Auditor Evaluation Form

Page 2 of 2

Approved By: Inspector General

Revision Level: I

Issue Date: 20.01.2025

Last Revised: 29.04.2025

Auditee Signature Date.....



Internal Audit Administrative Use Only: Evaluation Criteria & Weightings

Criterion	Weighting (%)	Rating (1-5)	Score (Rating / 5 * Weighting)
Technical Knowledge	20%		
Analytical Skills	15%		
Integrity and Confidentiality	15%		
Professionalism	15%		
Efficiency and Thoroughness	15%		
Leadership and Facilitation	10%		
Management of Time	10%		
Total	100%		
Overall Percentage			